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THURSDAY, MAY 15, 2025

CELTICS 127 KNICKS 102

Still down but they're not out

Missing injured Tatum, Boston has enough to extend series to Game 6



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Backup center Luke Kornet had a huge night for the Celtics, with 10 points, 9 rebounds, and 7 blocked shots.

They heard the rumblings about the end of their championship window, and new ownership coming in to break up the band, and the odious prospect of losing a conference semifinal series to the New York Knicks in five frustrating games.

They knew they'd have to play without their heartbeat franchise forward, Jayson Tatum, who suffered a season-ending ruptured Achilles' tendon Monday night in New York.

So what did they do?
The defending world champion Boston

DAN SHAUGHNESSY

COMMENTARY

Celtics came home to their Causeway Street gym and told the hoop world that they are not dead yet. Summoning their 3-point weaponry (shooting 22 of 49), they overcame a 9-point first-half deficit and thrashed the Knicks, 127-102, in Game 5 to move a suddenly scintillating series back to Madison Square Garden Friday night.

Underrated Derrick White led the way

with 34 points (he's Dennis Johnson with a Ray Allen jumper) and Jaylen Brown added 26 points, 8 rebounds, and 12 assists in a 37-minute tribute to lost brother Tatum. Unheralded Luke Kornet blocked seven shots, snatched nine rebounds, scored 10 points, and had a two-hand reverse dunk. Tommy Heinsohn would have said Luke was Russell-esque.

"The guys in that room have been together for a long time," said Celtics coach-under-siege Joe Mazzulla. "They were able to do

SHAUGHNESSY, Page C5

Harvard to make up some cuts in research

First infusion is \$250m, bringing tough decisions

By Brooke Hauser and Nick Stoico

GLOBE STAFF

Harvard University announced Wednesday that it will dedicate an initial \$250 million toward back-filling some of the Trump administration's research funding cuts to the university, which to date amount to nearly \$3 billion.

The cuts, which have escalated since Harvard sued the administration, have imperiled scientific projects and trials both planned and already in progress.

This initial infusion, taken from central funding, will complement "school-based resources and strategies" supporting affected research, Harvard University president Alan M. Garber and provost John F. Manning announced in a letter sent to the Harvard community Wednesday. They reaffirmed the university's "commitment to the research enterprise" amid the Trump administration's full-frontal assault on its financial and cultural capital.

"Although we cannot absorb the entire cost of the suspended or canceled federal funds, we will mobilize financial resources to support critical re-

HARVARD, Page A7

Lawmakers keep RFK Jr. on defensive

He has few answers on effect of widespread cuts

By Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When Senator Susan Collins, the Maine Republican, got her turn to question health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. during a committee hearing Wednesday, the exchange encapsulated the controversial appointee's highly anticipated return to Capitol Hill.

Collins, who voted to confirm Kennedy to the post in February, conveyed her concerns that widespread staff cuts at the Department of Health and Human Services would imperil federal Alzheimer's research programs authorized by legislation she authored.

How could Kennedy ensure the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention implements those programs, asked Collins, "when all of the staff responsible for that administration have either been placed on administrative leave or let go?"

"I don't know enough about that program," replied Kennedy. But, he suggested, it might have

KENNEDY, Page A6

Fiscal outlook uncertain, Healey freezes hiring

By Samantha J. Gross and Matt Stout

GLOBE STAFF

Responding to "widespread economic uncertainty at the national level," Governor Maura Healey's office is freezing hiring for much of state government, her office announced Wednesday.

The freeze, which will take effect May 27, comes as the state braces for the impacts of federal funding cuts and an unsettled economy. Most agencies and departments will not be

able to hire new employees; although some more critical positions will be exempt, officials said there will not be a formal waiver process to allow hiring managers to skirt the freeze on other jobs.

"The people of Massachusetts expect us to protect and maximize their tax dollars, and that's exactly what we're doing," Healey said in a statement. "Tariffs and funding cuts from Washington are causing so much economic damage and in-

HIRING, Page A7

In December 2022, Charlie Baker's final full month as governor, there were **42,900** executive branch employees. As of last June, that number has jumped **7%** to **45,910**.

Bus driver in crash that killed 5-year-old boy quits

Officials say he had expired certification

By John Hilliard

GLOBE STAFF

The Boston Public Schools bus driver who struck and killed a 5-year-old boy in Hyde Park in late April resigned Wednesday ahead of a scheduled termination hearing as more details emerged of the circumstances around the tragedy.

BUS, Page A7

Point32Health, the state's second-largest health insurer, is significantly scaling back its coverage of costly GLP-1 drugs when used for weight loss. D1.

A request by a witness to wear a niqab in court exposed a deep tension between the rights of religious expression and a defendant's right to confront an accuser. **B1.**

Boston's economy is among the strongest in the country and the city has a stable financial outlook, two premier credit rating agencies said. **D1.**

The EPA said it plans to weaken limits on some "forever chemicals" in drinking water. A6.



It's a coverup

Thursday: Gray, showers.

High 62-67. Low 55-60.

Friday: A little warmer.

High 69-74. Low 59-64.

Sunrise: 5:22 Sunset: 7:59

Weather and Comics, D5-6.
Obituaries, C9.



TRUMP IN THE MIDEAST

The president spoke Wednesday with Qatar's emir, Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani, and urged the country to use its influence over Iran. Earlier, he met with Syria's president, Ahmad al-Sharaa. **A3.**

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